FlowForge — Business Plan
PPiT Assignment 1

Team Members:

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- **M. Umar Shoaib (23L-0934)** — CTO & Technical Lead
- **Ahmad Rasheed (23L-0786)** — COO & Operations Manager
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Slogan	*Streamline. Automate. Scale.*
Website	https://flowforge-website-orpin.vercel.app

1. Company Overview

FlowForge is a B2B SaaS workflow automation platform designed to help small and mid-size businesses connect their tools, eliminate manual work, and scale operations without hiring large technical teams.

1.1 Vision

FlowForge aims to become the default platform for workflow automation among small and mid-size businesses, enabling them to operate with enterprise-level efficiency without enterprise-level overhead.

1.2 Mission

To connect tools, eliminate manual work, and help teams focus on high-value tasks by providing reliable, accessible workflow automation — deployable by any team, without custom development.

1.3 Business Idea

FlowForge offers an integration hub, a visual no-code workflow builder, and managed automation services. Companies connect CRM, support, billing, and productivity tools into fully automated workflows through a single platform — reducing friction and operational costs significantly.

1.4 Company Profile

Attribute	Detail
Company Name	FlowForge
Slogan	Streamline. Automate. Scale.
Type	B2B SaaS
Founded	2024
Headquarters	FAST-NUCES, Lahore, Pakistan
Website	https://flowforge-website-orpin.vercel.app

Hosting	Vercel (GitHub CI/CD, Auto-Deploy)

2. Problem Statement

Small and mid-size companies rely on multiple SaaS tools — Salesforce, Zendesk, Slack, QuickBooks — that do not integrate natively. Teams are forced to manually copy data between systems, creating significant operational inefficiency, errors, and scaling constraints.

2.1 Core Pain Points

Problem	Business Impact
Time Loss	Teams waste hours daily on repetitive copy-paste and manual status updates instead of value-adding work
Human Errors	Manual data entry causes mistakes, missed follow-ups, and unreliable reporting across departments
Operational Friction	Disconnected tools slow down onboarding, customer support response times, and sales velocity
Scaling Limits	Manual processes do not scale — headcount must grow linearly with work volume
Tool Complexity	Enterprise automation tools (Workato, MuleSoft) require dedicated IT staff and budgets far beyond SMB reach

2.2 The Market Gap

Most workflow automation platforms are designed for large enterprises. Small and mid-size businesses lack both the budget and the in-house expertise required to implement and maintain complex integrations. FlowForge bridges this gap by offering simple, no-code automation at SMB-friendly pricing, with an intuitive visual interface that requires no engineers to operate.

Key insight: The global workflow automation market is projected to exceed $26 billion by 2027 (CAGR: 23%). SMBs are the fastest-growing yet most underserved segment — representing FlowForge's primary opportunity.

3. Products & Services

FlowForge provides a suite of three core products and one managed service, each designed to address a different stage of a company's automation journey.

3.1 Workflow Automation Platform

A visual, drag-and-drop interface for designing triggers, conditions, and multi-step actions across 500+ connected applications. No coding required. Supports real-time execution, conditional branching, error handling, and version history.

3.2 Integration Hub

A central connector layer for CRM, support, billing, HR, and productivity tools. Includes pre-built connectors for Salesforce, Slack, Zendesk, and QuickBooks, plus a REST API for custom integrations. Supports OAuth 2.0, webhooks, and automated data mapping between systems.

3.3 Process Optimization Consulting

A consulting service where FlowForge analysts map the customer's existing workflows, identify operational bottlenecks, and propose specific automation opportunities with ROI estimates. Delivered as a one-time engagement or ongoing retainer.

3.4 Managed Automation Service

A white-glove service where FlowForge designs, deploys, monitors, and maintains all customer workflows. Includes a dedicated Customer Success Manager, SLA guarantees, 24/7 monitoring, quarterly review calls, and full incident response coverage. Ideal for companies that want automation without the internal overhead.

4. Target Market & Customer Segments

Segment	Description	Size Estimate
Primary — SMBs	50–500 employees with multiple disconnected SaaS tools and dedicated ops/support staff who handle manual data tasks daily	200,000+ companies
Secondary — Startups	10–50 employees scaling rapidly and needing automation without building an engineering team for internal tooling	500,000+ companies
Vertical Focus	E-commerce, professional services, SaaS companies, and healthcare administration — sectors with high process volume and multi-tool dependency	Combined TAM $26B+

4.1 Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Mid-market companies with two or more disconnected systems, a dedicated operations or support team that handles manual data work, monthly SaaS spend exceeding $5,000, and a desire to improve efficiency without hiring additional technical staff. Key decision makers are typically a VP of Operations, Head of Customer Success, or CTO.

5. Business Model & Revenue Strategy

5.1 Revenue Streams

- **Platform Subscription:** Recurring monthly or annual plans based on the number of workflows, integrations, and monthly task volume.
- **Professional Services:** One-time or retainer fees for process audits, implementation consulting, and workflow design.
- **Managed Automation:** A monthly managed service fee covering full deployment, monitoring, and maintenance of customer workflows.

5.2 Pricing Plans

Tier	Monthly Price	Includes
Starter	$99 / month	5 workflows, 3 integrations, community support
Growth ★	$299 / month	25 workflows, 15 integrations, email support
Scale	$799 / month	Unlimited workflows, all integrations, priority support
Enterprise	Custom pricing	Dedicated CSM, custom SLA, on-premise deployment option

5.3 Year 1 Revenue Projections

Quarter	Paying Customers	Avg. MRR / Customer	Monthly Revenue
Q1	40	$250	$10,000
Q2	120	$280	$33,600
Q3	280	$310	$86,800
Q4	500	$340	$170,000

6. Technology Stack

Each tool was selected for reliability, SMB-scale appropriateness, and ecosystem compatibility with FlowForge's integration-first architecture.

Layer	Tool / Technology	Purpose & Justification
Frontend	React + TypeScript	Component-based UI for the visual workflow builder. TypeScript ensures type safety across complex workflow state management logic.
Backend	Node.js / Express	Non-blocking API server for workflow orchestration, authentication, and real-time third-party API calls. High throughput per server instance.
Database	PostgreSQL	Relational database for users, workflows, and integration configs. ACID compliance ensures data integrity across all operations.
Job Queue	Redis + BullMQ	Asynchronous workflow task execution with automatic retries, delay scheduling, and per-integration rate limiting.
Cloud	AWS (EC2, S3, RDS)	Auto-scaling API servers on EC2, S3 for file storage, and managed RDS instances for the production database.
Website Hosting	Vercel	Zero-config deployments from GitHub with global CDN edge for fast public website delivery and automatic HTTPS.
Payments	Stripe	Subscription billing, usage-based pricing tiers, invoicing, and PCI-compliant payment processing.
Analytics	PostHog	Open-source product analytics for tracking feature adoption, activation funnels, and in-product user behaviour.
Monitoring	Datadog	APM, logs, real-time alerts, and dashboards ensuring 99.9% uptime SLA with instant incident detection and response.

Authentication	Auth0 / JWT	Enterprise-ready SSO, multi-factor authentication, and OAuth 2.0 for securely linking third-party application accounts.

7. Marketing & Sales Strategy

7.1 Inbound Marketing

- **SEO Content Marketing:** Blog guides covering workflow automation, integration step-by-step tutorials, and SMB productivity topics — targeting 50+ high-intent search keywords to drive organic traffic.
- **Free 14-Day Trial:** A fully featured free trial with guided onboarding sequences to maximise product activation and conversion to paid plans.
- **Customer Case Studies:** Published ROI reports documenting time savings and error reduction achieved by real customers — used in sales and content marketing.
- **YouTube Channel:** Video walkthroughs demonstrating common workflow templates including CRM sync, support ticket routing, and billing reconciliation automation.

7.2 Outbound Sales

- **Targeted Cold Outreach:** Personalised emails and LinkedIn messages sent to VP Operations, Head of Customer Success, and CTO roles at ICP-qualifying accounts.
- **Partner Ecosystem:** Referral and white-label partnerships with CRM, support ticketing, and billing software vendors whose customers are a strong fit for FlowForge.
- **Event Sponsorship:** Presence and sponsorships at SaaS, operations strategy, and business productivity conferences and virtual summits.

7.3 Sales Motion by Tier

Pricing Tier	Sales Approach	Avg. Sales Cycle
Starter & Growth	Self-serve signup via website — no sales involvement required	Instant (web signup)
Scale	SDR outreach → discovery call → live product demo → 30-day trial	2–4 weeks
Enterprise	Account-based selling → security and legal review → custom contract with SLA	2–3 months

8. Company Structure & Employee Roles

8.1 Founding Team

- **M. Abdul Raheem (23L-0588) — CEO & Founder:** Responsible for overall strategy, investor relations, key partnerships, and company-level OKRs and executive decision-making.
- **M. Umar Shoaib (23L-0934) — CTO & Technical Lead:** Owns platform architecture, engineering culture, system security, and technical product roadmap. Leads all engineering and product functions.
- **Ahmad Rasheed (23L-0786) — COO & Operations Manager:** Manages delivery quality, customer support operations, process design, and inter-department coordination to ensure smooth day-to-day operations.
- **Nouman Hassan (23L-0782) — CFO & Marketing Lead:** Controls financial planning, budget allocation, brand strategy, and go-to-market execution across inbound and outbound channels.

8.2 Employees Beyond Founders

Role	Key Responsibilities	Required Skills
Software Engineer ×3	Build and maintain platform features, integration connectors, and internal tooling	Node.js, React, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, REST APIs
Solutions Architect	Design custom integrations and complex multi-step workflows for enterprise customers	API design, system design, customer consulting
UI/UX Designer	Design the workflow builder interface, onboarding flows, and the public marketing website	Figma, user research, interaction design, accessibility
Sales Executive ×2	Prospecting, discovery calls, product demos, and closing for Growth and Scale tiers	B2B SaaS sales, CRM tools, negotiation
Customer Success Manager	Customer onboarding, adoption coaching, renewal management, and upsell identification	Product expertise, account management, support tools

Customer Support Specialist	Handle Tier-1 support tickets, write help documentation, escalate issues to engineering	Zendesk, clear written communication, product knowledge
Data Analyst	Product usage analytics, revenue reporting, and customer health scoring for CSM team	SQL, PostHog, Metabase, data modeling and dashboarding

8.3 Organisational Structure

The company operates with a flat leadership structure where the four founders each lead a functional division. All divisions report to the CEO.

- **CEO — M. Abdul Raheem (23L-0588):** Strategy · Partnerships · Vision
    - **CTO — M. Umar Shoaib (23L-0934):** Software Engineers ×3 · Solutions Architect · UI/UX Designer
    - **COO — Ahmad Rasheed (23L-0786):** Customer Success Manager · Customer Support Specialist
    - **CFO — Nouman Hassan (23L-0782):** Sales Executives ×2 · Data Analyst

9. Operational Workflow

The FlowForge customer lifecycle follows a structured six-stage process from initial contact through annual renewal and expansion:

Stage 1 — Lead Generation

Leads arrive via inbound channels (website, SEO-driven content, paid search) or outbound SDR prospecting. All leads are captured in HubSpot CRM and automatically scored based on ICP fit and behavioural intent signals such as content engagement and trial sign-up activity.

Stage 2 — Qualify

A Sales Executive or Customer Success Manager conducts a 30-minute discovery call to align with ICP criteria — company size, tools currently in use, specific pain points, and available budget. Leads not matching the ICP are routed to the self-serve free trial directly. Qualified leads proceed to guided onboarding.

Stage 3 — Onboard

ICP customers receive a guided setup session (Growth tier) or a fully managed implementation experience (Managed Automation tier). All key integrations are connected, and the customer's first production automation workflow is deployed within 48 hours of contract signing.

Stage 4 — Adopt

The Customer Success Manager delivers training sessions, provides curated documentation, and sets 30/60/90-day success milestones aligned to the customer's goals. Usage is tracked in PostHog — low adoption rates trigger proactive CSM outreach and additional training sessions.

Stage 5 — Support

Support is tiered for efficiency: Tier 1 (Customer Support Specialist handles common issues using documented help articles), Tier 2 (Solutions Architect resolves complex configuration and integration issues), and Tier 3 (Engineering resolves platform bugs and outages). First-response SLA target is under four hours for paid tiers.

Stage 6 — Renew & Expand

Quarterly Business Reviews conducted by the CSM identify upsell opportunities such as additional integrations, plan upgrades, or managed service add-ons. Renewal processes are initiated 60 days before contract expiry to systematically prevent churn and negotiate multi-year agreements.

10. Future Growth & Scalability

10.1 Growth Roadmap

Timeframe	Milestones
Near Term (0–12 months)	Reach 500 paying customers · Expand to 750+ integrations · Launch iOS and Android mobile app · Achieve SOC 2 Type II certification · Close seed funding round ($1.5M target)
Mid Term (12–36 months)	EMEA and APAC geographic expansion · Launch AI-assisted workflow suggestion engine · Publish vertical-specific template libraries (healthcare, finance) · Build partner and reseller programme · Series A fundraise ($8M target)
Long Term (36+ months)	Open workflow template marketplace for community-built automations · Offer on-premise and private cloud deployment options · Build AI agent automation layer for fully autonomous workflows · Position for IPO or strategic acquisition

10.2 Technical Scalability

Infrastructure Layer	Scaling Strategy
Application Servers	Horizontal auto-scaling on AWS ECS with Kubernetes-ready container orchestration for future multi-region deployment
Job Queue / Workers	Redis and BullMQ worker clusters that scale independently per workflow execution volume, with queue partitioning by customer tier
Database	PostgreSQL read replicas for analytics and reporting workloads, with PgBouncer connection pooling to handle traffic spikes without database overload
Multi-tenancy	Schema-per-tenant database isolation ensures data security, regulatory compliance, and consistent performance across all customer accounts

10.3 Live Website

The FlowForge website is publicly accessible and includes all four required pages: Home, Services, About Us (with all team members listed), and Contact. The site is hosted on Vercel with automatic CI/CD deployment from the connected GitHub repository.

Website URL: https://flowforge-website-orpin.vercel.app